

Scratch — Mini Catch Game

Let's learn coding by making a fun catching game!

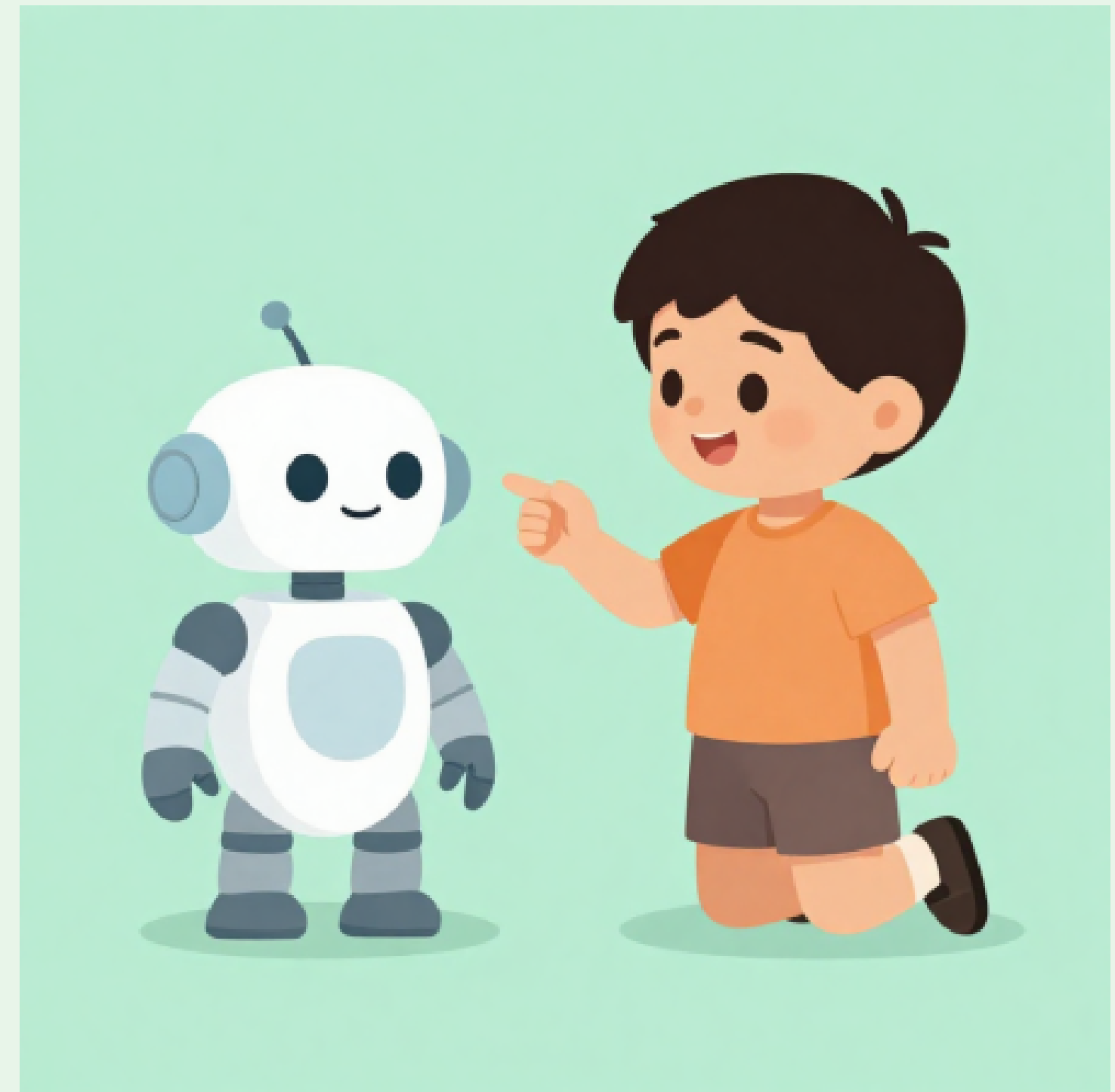


What is Coding?

Coding is telling the computer what to do by giving it step-by-step instructions.

Just like you follow steps to make a sandwich, computers follow steps we write!

Coding helps us create games, stories, and solve problems.



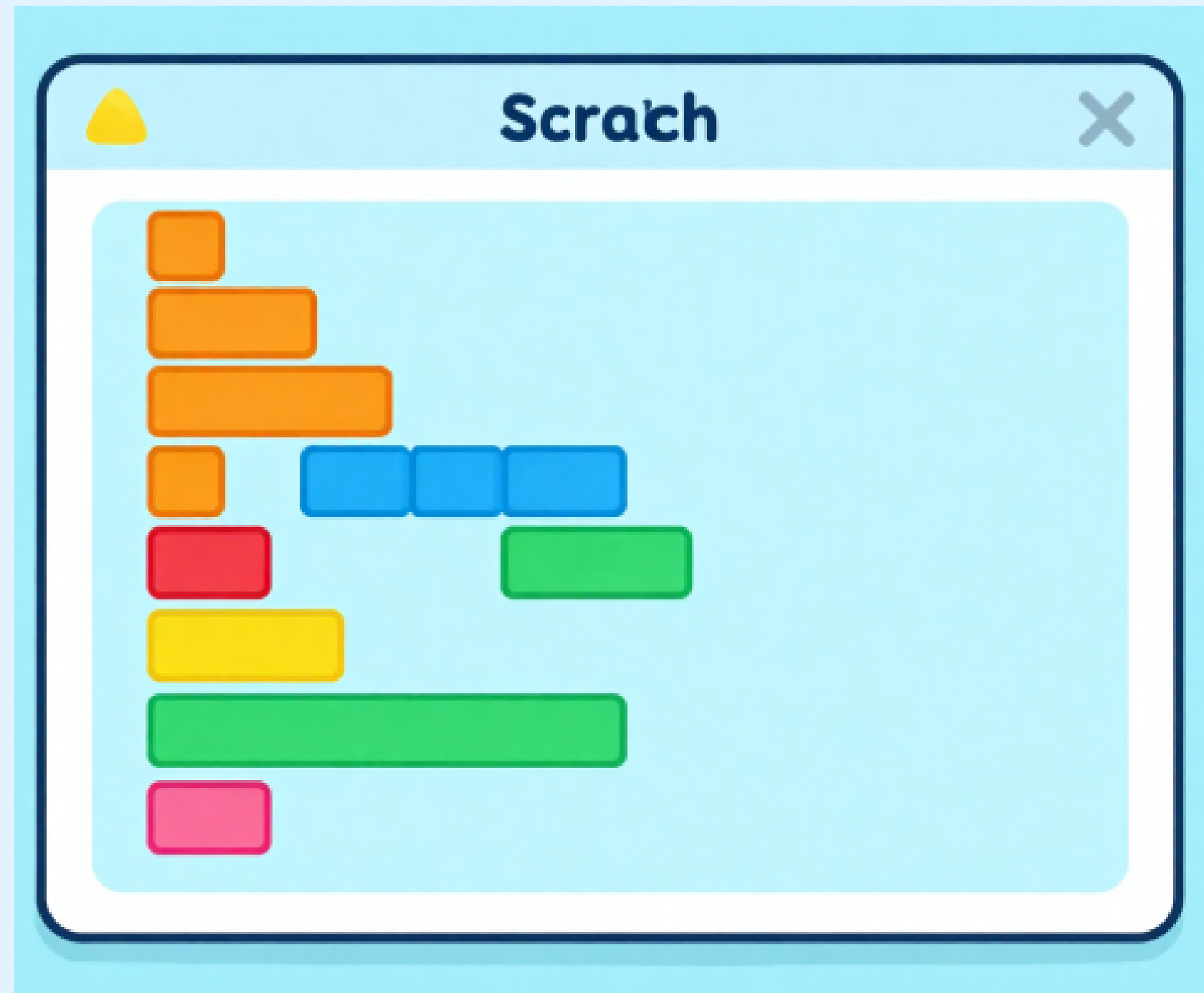
Why Scratch?

Scratch uses colourful blocks to code.
No typing needed — just drag and drop!

With Scratch you can:

- Create fun games
- Make animations
- Tell interactive stories

It is free and made for kids like you!

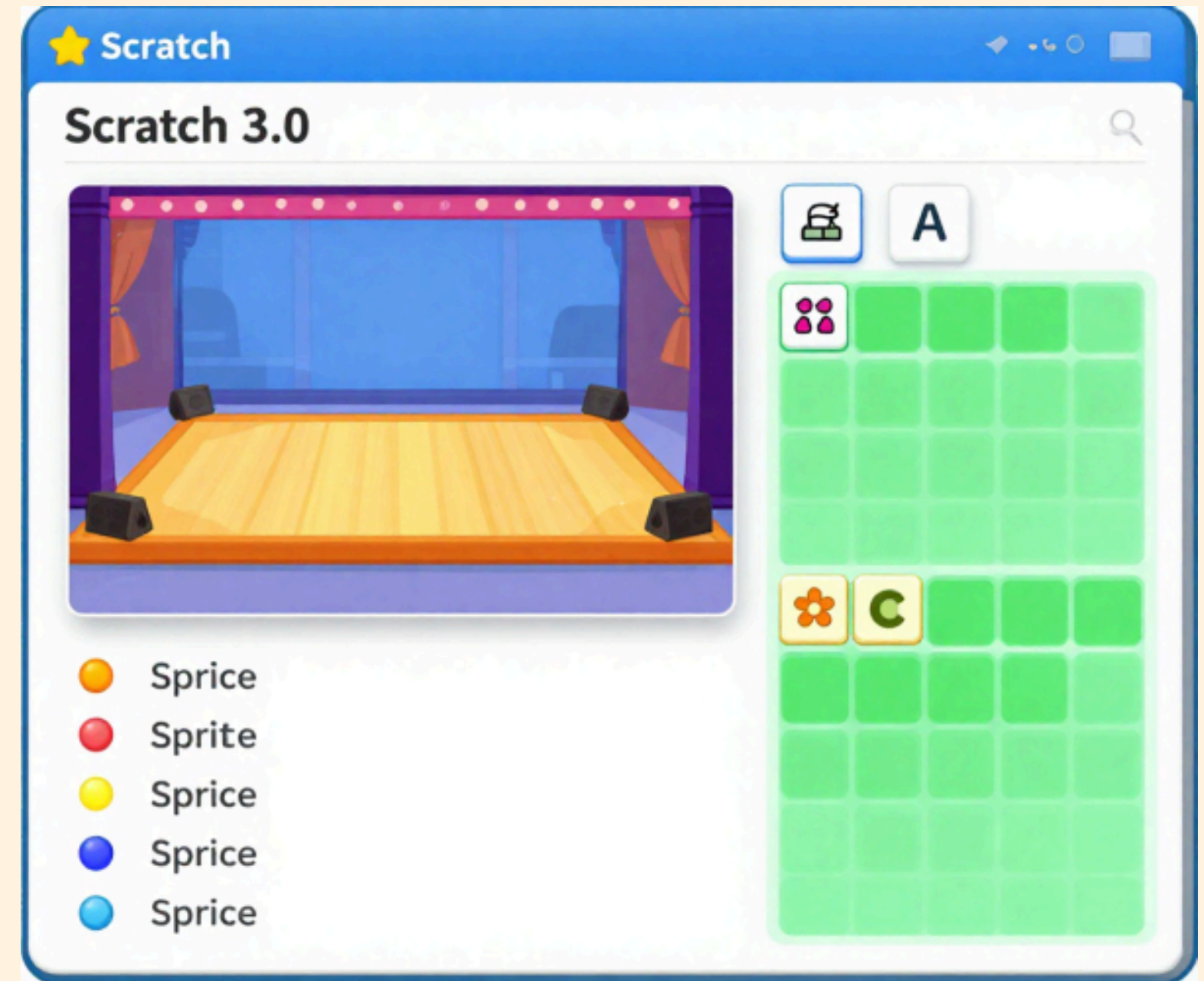


Meet the Scratch Interface

The Scratch screen has 3 main parts:

1. Stage — where your game plays
2. Sprite List — your characters appear here
3. Code Area — drag blocks here to code

Click the green flag to run your code.
Click the red stop to end it.



Sprites — Your Game Characters

Sprites are characters or objects in your game.

For our catch game we need:

- A bowl sprite (to catch things)
- A fruit sprite (the falling object)

You can pick sprites from the Scratch library or draw your own!

Click the cat icon to choose a sprite.



What is a Mini Catch Game?

In a catch game:

- Objects fall from the top of the screen
- You move a bowl left and right
- Catch the falling fruit to score points!

The more you catch, the higher your score.

Let us build this game step by step using Scratch blocks!



Coding Blocks We Will Use

Scratch has colourful blocks for coding:

- Motion blocks (blue) — move sprites
- Events blocks (yellow) — start actions
- Control blocks (orange) — repeat and check
- Sensing blocks (cyan) — detect touching
- Variables (red) — keep score

We drag and snap blocks together like puzzle pieces!



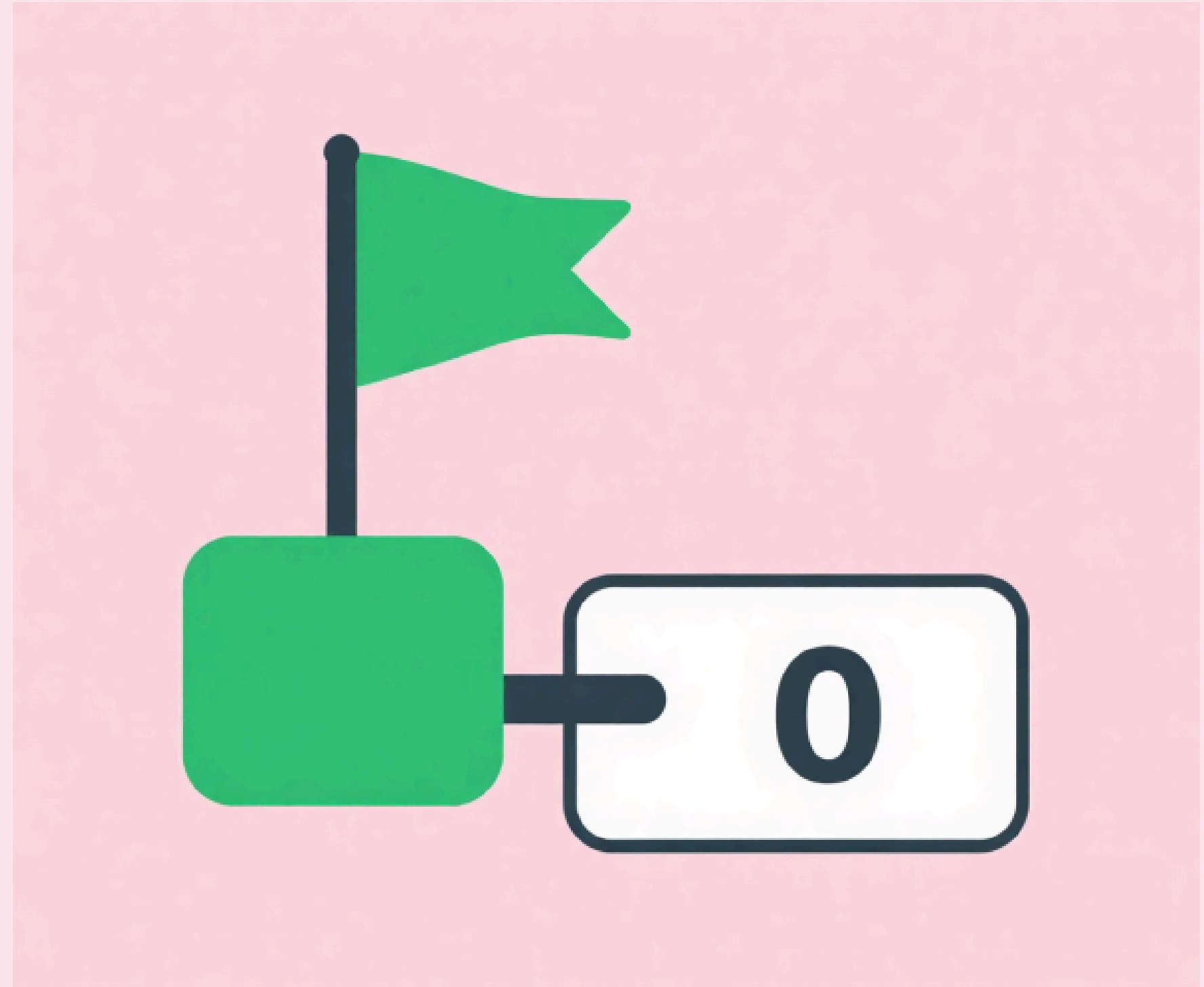
Step 1: Start the Game

Every Scratch game starts with:

When green flag clicked

This block tells the computer:
"Begin the game now!"

We also set the score to 0
so it starts fresh each time.



Step 2: Move the Bowl

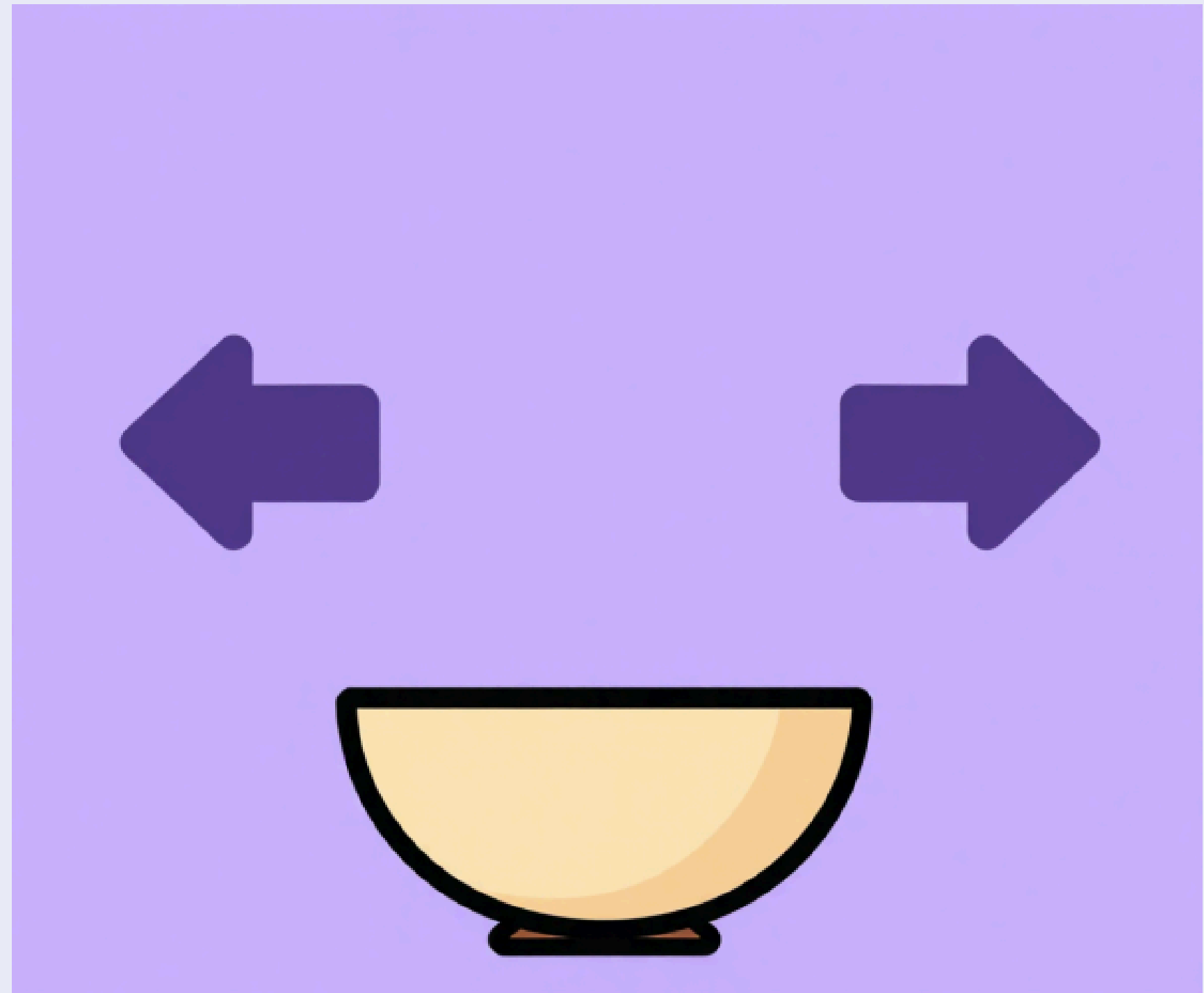
We use arrow keys to move the bowl:

- Press RIGHT arrow → bowl moves right
- Press LEFT arrow → bowl moves left

The code uses:

When right arrow key pressed
Change x by 10

This makes the bowl slide along the bottom!

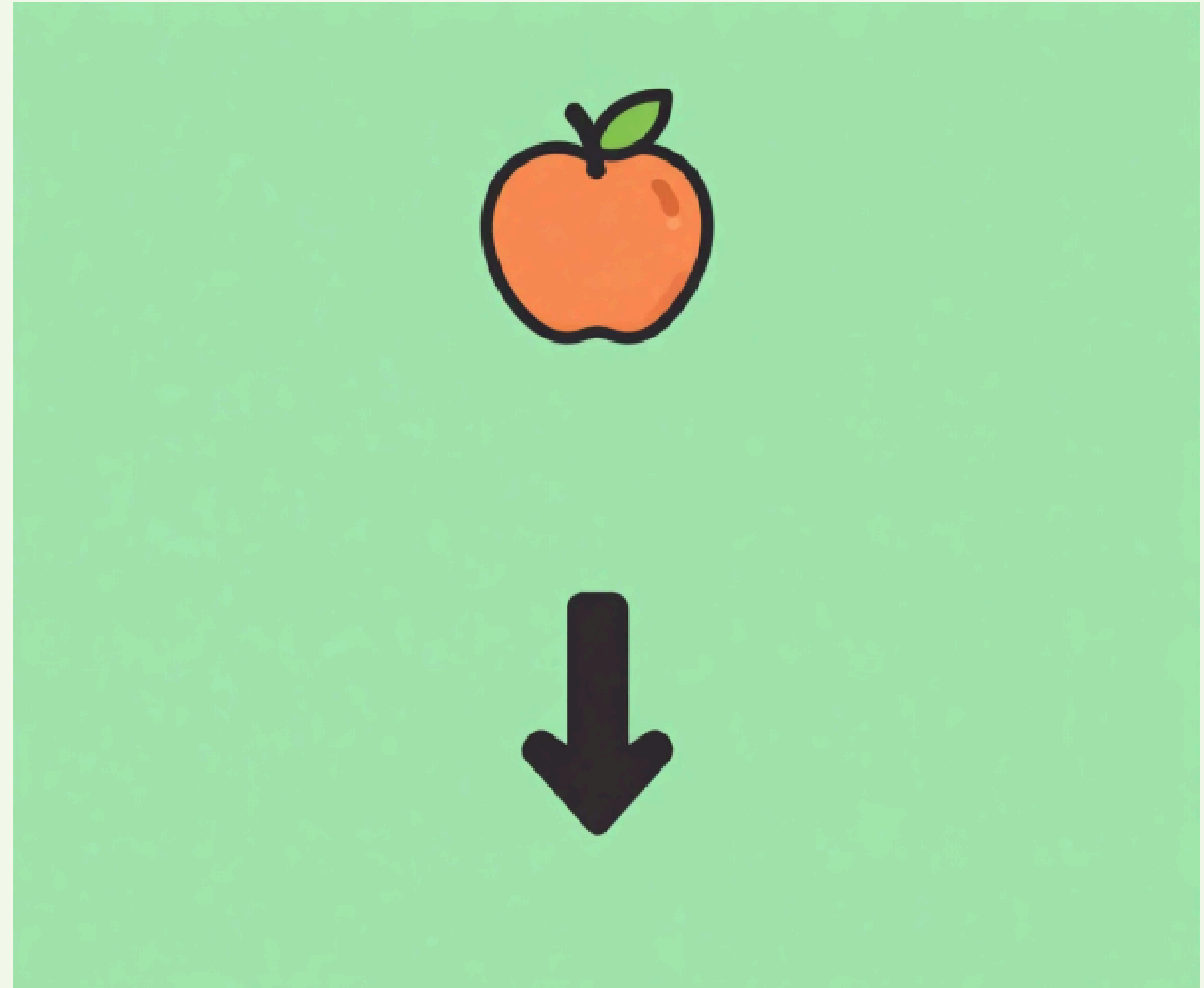


Step 3: Make Fruit Fall

The fruit starts at the top and falls down:

1. Go to a random spot at the top
2. Slowly move down (change y by -5)
3. Repeat until it reaches the bottom
4. If it reaches the bottom, go back to top

We use a forever loop to keep it falling!



Step 4: Catch the Fruit!

How does the game know you caught it?

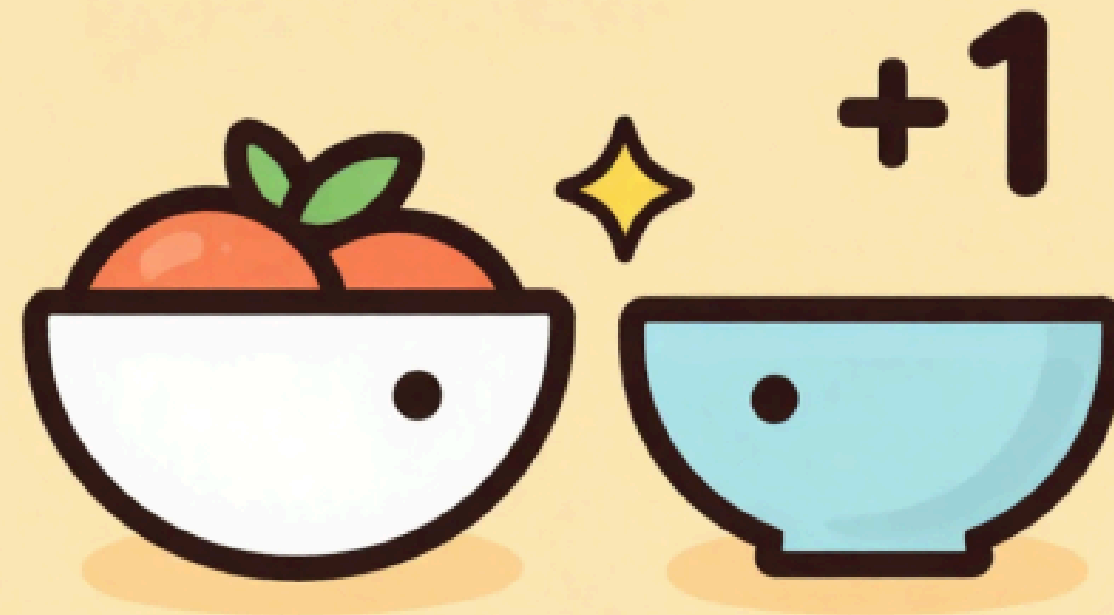
We use the sensing block:

- If touching bowl? then...

- Add 1 to score

- Move fruit back to top

When the fruit touches the bowl,
you get a point! Well done!



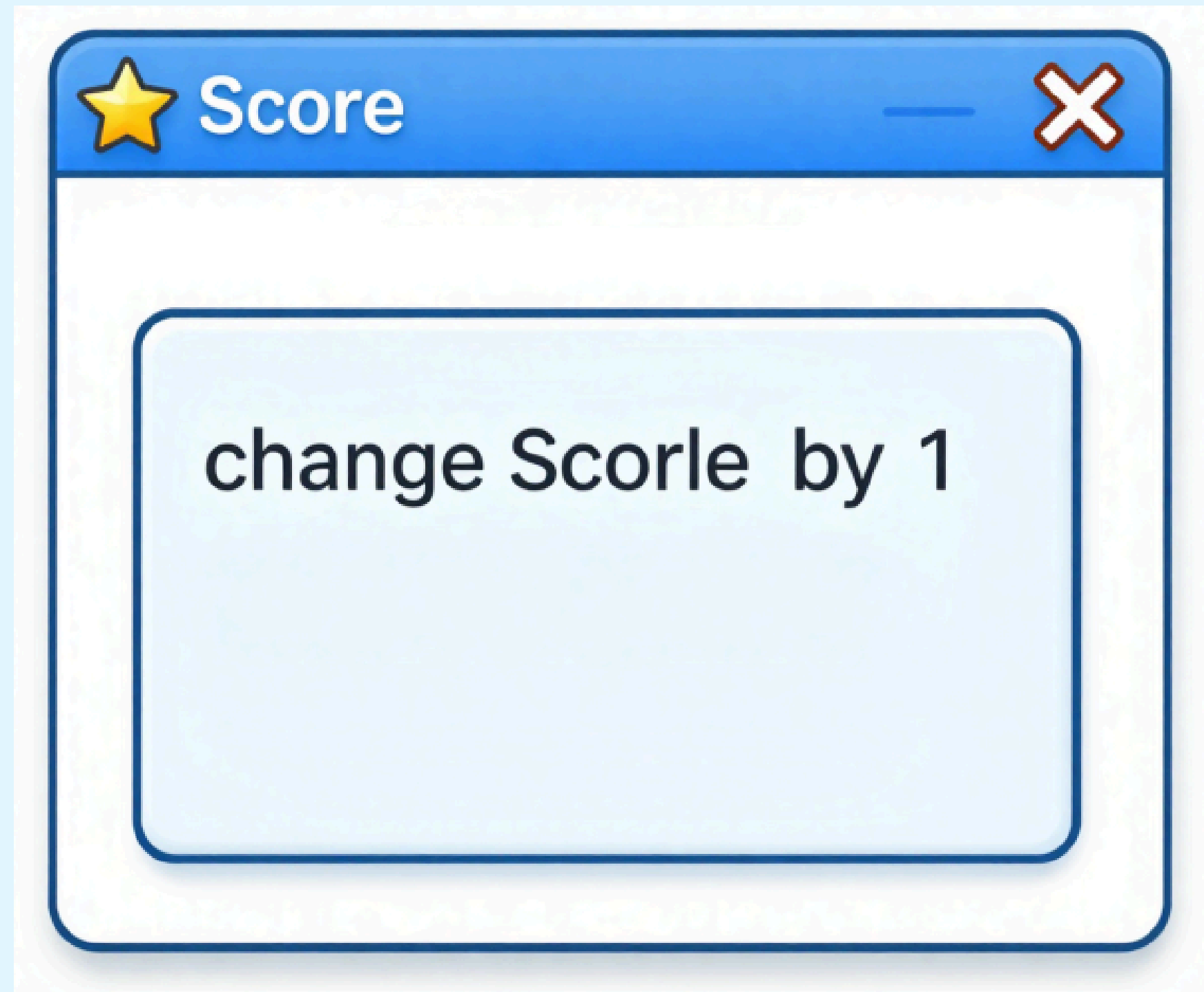
Step 5: Keeping Score

We need a variable to count points!

Go to Variables and click
'Make a Variable' — call it Score.

Every time you catch a fruit:
Change Score by 1

The score shows on the stage
so you can see your points!



Step 6: Add Fun Sounds!

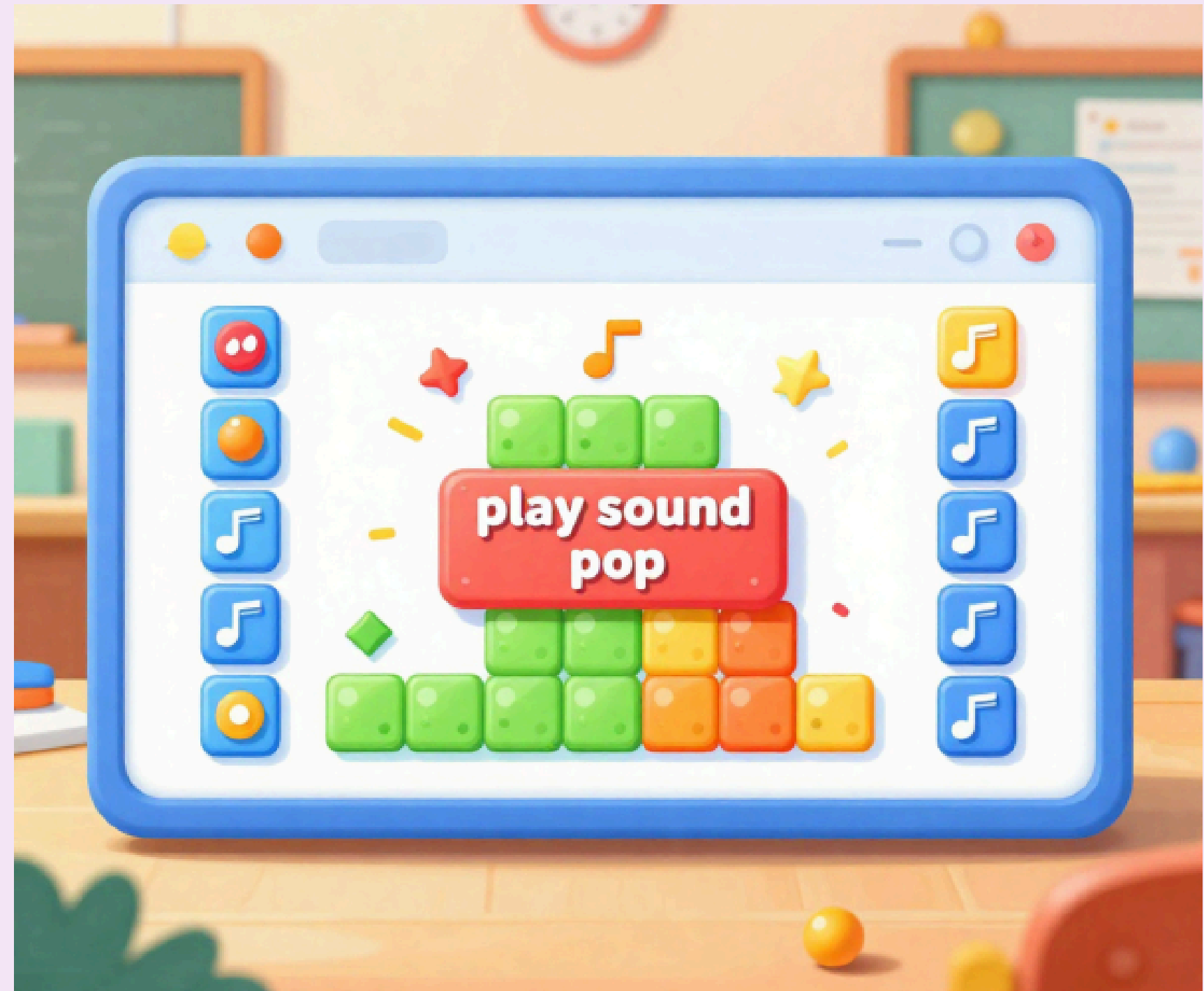
Make your game exciting with sounds!

When you catch a fruit, play a sound:

Play sound 'Pop'

You can pick sounds from the Scratch sound library.

Try 'Chomp' or 'Collect' too!
Sounds make games more fun.



Test Your Game!

Time to play! Click the green flag.

Use arrow keys to move the bowl.
Catch the falling fruits!

Check:

- Does the bowl move left and right?
- Does the fruit fall down?
- Does the score go up when you catch?

If yes — your game works!



Fix Common Problems

Game not working? Try these fixes:

- Bowl not moving?
Check your arrow key event blocks.
- Fruit not falling?
Check the loop and Y position change.
- Score not counting?
Check the 'if touching' block.

Ask your teacher if you need help!



What We Learned Today

Great job! Today we learned:

- Sprites are game characters
- Motion blocks move sprites
- Loops make things repeat
- Sensing blocks detect touching
- Variables keep score

You built a real game in Scratch!
You are a coder now!

